

Another reason that it can be hard to derive satisfaction from good financial habits is that, as we've discussed, we can have a tendency to assume that having a good relationship with money and looking after ourselves financially is 'the norm', and that we don't deserve congratulating for it. But, as I hope you've come to realize, that really isn't the case for a lot of people. We all deserve to gain real satisfaction from practising financial self-care, because, against a tidal wave of pressure to borrow and consume, it can actually be really, really difficult.

### **Exercise: Find an accountability buddy**

As you start to break the habits that are holding you back, and form new ones that will propel you forwards, an accountability partner will be invaluable in keeping you on track. We're so used to holding our financial cards close to our chest, because of the stigma and shame that surround money, that it can be really difficult to find somebody that you trust enough to partner up with – but it's so worth it. Your first port of call might be friends and family, and if there's someone inside that sphere who you feel comfortable talking to about money, that's brilliant. Otherwise, this is an area where social media can be brilliantly helpful. There are growing online communities, including my own Instagram page, where honest conversation about money is the order of the day – and you might find a like-minded